

art Varied Fare

CHENNAI Alliance Française de Madras (AFM) plays host to an array of exhibitions, film and book festivals and a music workshop. V. Vinoth's exhibition of photographs (till October 28) titled 'Nirvana' showcases "sleeping people arrested in their immobility". This is Vinoth's attempt to portray people's "hope of happily abandoning their difficulties at least during their sleep".

For the movie buffs, AFM is presenting movies with historical themes. The list includes the legendary Tamil film *Veerapandiya Kattabomman* (on October 10); *1492, Christophe Colomb*

CANNOT CHANGE ANYTHING.



Vinoth's sleeping people (on October 8); *Kappal Oatiya Tamilan* (on October 11) and *Austerlitz* (on October 12). On October 13, classical musician Sikkil Gurucharan and pianist Anil Srinivasan will conduct a two-hour workshop on their musical idiom. They will highlight the thought process behind the making of *Madhirakshi*, the

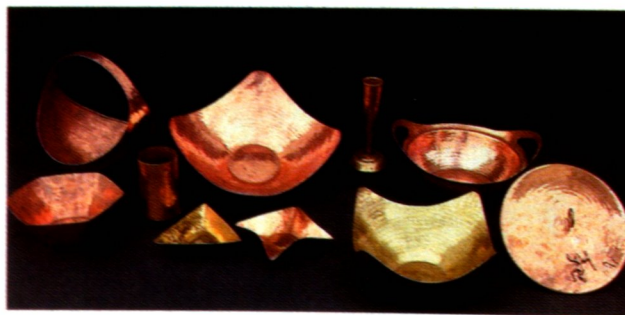
duo's collaborative effort that aesthetically combines the classical and contemporary vocabulary of music. The workshop will be followed by a preview of their ongoing work, 'The Colour of Rain'. The books festival (October 19) revolves around the theme 'A City, A Book'. At No. 24, College Road, Nungambakkam.

by Akhila Krishnamurthy

recommendations Mixed Match

MUMBAI The 10-day-long Dastakari Haat Samiti exhibition at Mumbai's Coomaraswamy Hall will see artisans from across the country showcase their craft. On display will be painted Rajasthani toys, palm leaf baskets from Tamil Nadu, ethnic jewellery and artefacts, fabrics and ethnic weaves in dramatic designs on scarves, sarees and bed-covers and hand-woven shawls from Kutch. The non-profit organisation will also display crafts maps, design developments in embroideries of Jharkhand and tribal Gondi paintings on silk bags and pouches. From October 4 to 14.

by Aditi Pai



KOLKATA Aakriti Art Gallery celebrates its second anniversary this month with a unique show of paintings and sculptures by 40 Indian artists below 40 called Gen Next II. The exhibition displays our modern lives reflected in art through the works of these artists, who are equally at home with modern technology as with gender issues. The



A Chandra Das creation

Ethnic craft in Mumbai artists have no uncertainties about combining images and information from a broad range of sources and placing them within new contexts. Some of the participating artists are Akhil Chandra Das, Amlan Dutta, Apu Dasgupta, Nobina Gupta, S. Gopinath, Suman Choudhury, Supam Adhikary, Tapas Biswas and others. On till October 15.

by Swagata Sen

dance In Celebration

DELHI Seher organises a classical Indian dance festival Ananya: The Unparalleled from October 11-15, where dancers will perform against the backdrop of the majestic Purana Qila. It is a symphony of classical Indian dance with an ancient monument. It celebrates the beauty of the classical dance form with an emphasis on group choreography. Drawn from different styles, the dancers explore Indian traditions and also experiment with contemporary themes. A highlight this year will be an



An aural and visual treat

interactive session between the artistes and the audience on October 13 and 14 at the India International Centre. The line-up includes Bharatanatyam by Chandrasekhar's Nrityashree (Chennai), Kuchipudi by Kalanidhi Dance (USA), Odissi by Odissi Dance Academy (Bhubaneswar), contemporary dance by Samudra (Thiruvananthapuram) and Kathak by Gitanjali Lal (Delhi). Definitely a visual and aural treat for the Capital's audience. by S. Sahaya Rani